

Auto and Home Insurance Sales

Standard Operating Procedure

Document Reference	SOP-INS-008
Version	2.2
Effective Date	01 March 2025
Review Date	01 March 2026
Owner	Personal Lines Distribution
Approved By	Head of Personal Lines
Classification	Internal Use Only
Applicable To	All agent-assisted auto and home insurance sales across Meridian Insurance Group's personal lines distribution network

1. Purpose

This SOP defines the process for identifying, quoting, and converting prospects into auto and home insurance policyholders through the Meridian agent distribution channel. It establishes consistent sales conduct standards, underwriting discipline, and documentation requirements to maximise conversion while maintaining product profitability and regulatory compliance.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to:

- Agent-sourced and inbound enquiries for personal auto and home insurance products
- New business sales, cross-sales between auto and home, and account rounding opportunities
- Applications submitted via the Meridian agent portal or telephony channel

This procedure does NOT cover: online direct sales without agent involvement (SOP-INS-001), commercial vehicle fleets, or landlord insurance beyond standard residential.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Insurance Representative (Personal Lines Agent)	Identifies prospects; conducts needs analysis; presents product options; completes application; manages customer relationship post-sale.
Underwriter	Reviews referral cases outside auto-accept parameters; approves or declines; sets non-standard terms or exclusions.
Claims Processor	Provides historical claims data for underwriting verification when requested; supports agent in communicating claims impact to prospect.
Customer Service / Call Centre	Handles inbound enquiries; provides quotes; escalates complex cases to licensed agents; processes applications for channel-assisted sales.

4. Pre-requisites and Triggers

Triggered by a prospect enquiry (inbound or agent-sourced) or a referral from an existing policyholder. The agent must be actively licensed and appointed by Meridian before initiating a sale.

5. Process Steps

5.1 Prospect Identification and Needs Analysis

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
1	Prospect identified via referral, campaign lead, or inbound enquiry	Agent / Customer Service	Prospect record created in CRM; source code recorded
2	Initial contact made and appointment scheduled	Agent	Contact within 1 business day of lead assignment; appointment confirmed in CRM

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
3	Needs analysis conducted	Agent	Current insurer, coverage gaps, claims history, and risk characteristics discussed; notes recorded in CRM
4	Multi-product opportunity assessed	Agent	If prospect has both auto and home needs, bundled discount opportunity presented

5.2 Quotation

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
5	Application data entered into agent portal	Agent	Vehicle details (auto), property details (home), personal and claims history entered; address verified
6	Rating engine generates premium	Agent Portal / Rating Engine	Instant quote returned for auto-accept cases; referral cases routed to Underwriting
7	Quote presented and explained to prospect	Agent	Product benefits, exclusions, excess/deductible, and payment options explained per Product Disclosure obligations
8	Underwriting review (if referred)	Underwriter	Decision within 2 business hours; agent notified of outcome and revised terms if applicable

5.3 Conversion and Policy Issuance

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
9	Prospect agrees to proceed; application finalised	Agent / Prospect	Application signed (digital or paper); agent confirms scope of cover and confirms prospect understood
10	First premium payment collected	Agent / Payment Gateway	Payment processed via agent portal; receipt issued
11	Policy issued in PAS	Agent Portal / PAS	Policy number generated; coverage effective from agreed start date
12	Policy documents dispatched to policyholder	PAS (auto)	Schedule, Certificate, PDS dispatched within 2 business days
13	CRM updated with sale outcome	Agent	Policy number, premium, product type, and commission logged

6. Decision Points and Exception Handling

6.1 Prospect Declines Quote

- Agent records declination with reason code in CRM; follow-up task set for 30 days
- If price was the objection: agent may request pricing review from Underwriting if property/vehicle risk profile warrants exception

6.2 High-Risk Property or Vehicle

- Applications with risk characteristics outside standard guidelines are held for underwriting review before any verbal commitment to the prospect
- Agent must not communicate binding confirmation until formal Underwriting approval is received in writing

6.3 Misrepresentation Identified

- If material information is found to be misrepresented post-issuance, Underwriting and Compliance are notified within 1 business day
- Policy is placed under review; Compliance determines whether policy is void or voidable and advises on required action

7. Systems and Tools

System / Tool	Purpose	Access
Agent Portal (Meridian Connect)	Quotation, application submission, policy issuance, document download	Agent
Policy Administration System (PAS)	Policy record, document generation, endorsements	Agent, Customer Service, Underwriting
CRM (Salesforce)	Prospect and customer records, pipeline, communication history	Agent, Customer Service
Rating Engine	Auto and home premium calculation, bureau integration	Automated
Payment Gateway	Premium collection, receipt generation	Agent, Customer Service

8. Key Performance Indicators

- Lead-to-quote rate: Minimum 70% of assigned leads result in a formal quotation
- Quote-to-bind conversion: Minimum 28% of quotes converted to bound policies
- Cross-product attach rate: Minimum 35% of auto new business written with an associated home policy
- Sales conduct compliance: Zero upheld complaints per 1,000 policies related to misrepresentation or inadequate disclosure
- Policy issuance SLA: 100% of new policies issued and documents dispatched within 2 business days of payment

9. Related Documents

- SOP-INS-001: Online Insurance Sales
- SOP-INS-004: Prospect-to-Issue
- SOP-INS-010: Policy Endorsement and Mid-Term Adjustment

- POL-UW-001: Personal Lines Underwriting Policy
- POL-COMP-004: Product Disclosure and Sales Conduct Policy

10. Document Control and Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	15 Jan 2021	H. Mendez, Personal Lines	Initial release
2.0	01 Mar 2023	H. Mendez, Personal Lines	Migrated to Meridian Connect agent portal; updated referral workflow
2.1	10 Sep 2024	B. Osei, Underwriting	Added misrepresentation exception; updated cross-sell KPI targets
2.2	01 Mar 2025	B. Osei, Underwriting	Aligned to revised product disclosure obligations; updated payment gateway steps